

COINPICKS · RESEARCH & EDUCATION

Iran War Risk Pillar Report

Middle East Conflict Risk — Researched, Scored, and Personally Committed

*Originally written June 19, 2026; scores committed by me June 19, 2026. Fully re-researched & updated on July 10, 2026 against live primary sources (previous update July 8, 2026) — the re-rated scores in this version are **DRAFT**, awaiting my stamp.*

COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 25% OF MY THESIS

Written June 19, 2026 · Updated & Re-verified July 10, 2026 · Not Financial Advice

The Scores — Committed vs. Drafts

June column committed by me June 19, 2026 · Jul 8 draft re-rated July 8 · Jul 10 draft re-rated July 10, 2026 — awaiting my stamp

WINDOW	MY JUNE P	JUL 8 DRAFT	JUL 10 DRAFT	QUALITY	IMPACT	SIGNAL	MY CALL
1 month	50	40	42	0.60	7	-0.7	Mild Bear — strike-pause-strike regime
3 months	55	47	49	0.65	7	-0.1	Neutral
6 months	62	55	56	0.70	7	+0.6	Mild Bull
1 year	75	70	70	0.65	7	+1.8	Bull (dip-buy, delayed)
3 years	85	83	83	0.55	7	+2.5	Bull

Draft P (Jul 10): 42 / 49 / 56 / 70 / 83 · **My Weight:** 25% · **My Impact:** 7 · **Formula:** Signal = $((P - 50) \div 50) \times \text{Quality} \times \text{Impact}$. Lineage: June committed 50 / 55 / 62 / 75 / 85 (June 19, 2026) → July 8 draft 40 / 47 / 55 / 70 / 83 → July 10 draft — awaiting my stamp.

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

P — the odds this is *good for crypto* by then. Near-term still *below* a coin flip: the ceasefire is "over" per Trump, ~170 targets were struck across two nights (July 8–9), and Hormuz sits at its worst readings of the crisis. But the July 9–10 tape beat the July 8 worst case — **zero US casualties** across both days, Iran's four-country retaliation almost fully intercepted, a Friday pause, and Iran asking to keep talking — so the near windows nudge up, not down. Long-term still high — these same two sides walked back from the brink twice this year (April 8, June 8), and war shocks have historically faded.

Quality — how trustworthy the evidence is. The near-term windows carry live fog-of-war (Hormuz traffic estimates conflict 50% vs 92% reduction; the July 11 talks date is a single-source relay); the multi-year read still leans on a thin sample, so Quality tops at 0.70 and falls to 0.55. Every source is on the last page — click and judge for yourself.

Impact — 7 out of 10, unchanged. Even ~170 US strikes on Iranian targets over two nights left BTC ending the week *up* ~4% near \$64K — with the rally attributed to chips and the yen, not Iran. A war shock hits crypto hard for days — but it stays one input among many.

The Claim

The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated July 10, 2026

The crowd: "the ceasefire is over" — Trump repeated it Friday, in capitals. ~170 targets struck inside Iran in two nights, bridges hit for the first time since April, IRGC missiles at four countries including Jordan — its first strike there since June 11, Hormuz on the US Navy-led JMIC's highest "severe" advisory. The loud story is pure risk-off: stay out until it's over.

Me: near-term I'm still with the bears — 42% good-for-crypto at 1 month, because a strike-pause-strike regime with a severe-shut strait can re-fire any night. But the tape beat the worst case: zero US casualties, retaliation that was almost fully intercepted (performative, not lethal), a Friday lull, and Iran asking to continue talks. The arc holds: 83% over three years. The dip is still a buy — it just isn't fully formed yet.

My edge: the market is telling you what it thinks — oil *fell* to ~\$76 despite 170 targets struck (de-escalation being priced), and BTC decoupled and rallied +3.5% to near \$64K on July 10, explicitly on chips, yen, and dollar weakness, not Iran. The risk isn't the headlines the crowd fears; it's the quiet paths — a US-casualty event, a formal MoU death by ~Aug 16, a confirmed full Hormuz closure. I watch those, not the noise.

The Facts

As of July 10, 2026 — hard numbers only, sources on the last page. ★ = new since July 8

- ★ **Second strike wave, July 9:** after ~80 targets on July 8 (Sirik, Qeshm Island, Bandar Abbas area), CENTCOM struck **~90 more targets** early July 9 — second consecutive night, **~170 cumulative** — across Tehran, Bandar Abbas, Bushehr province, Chabahar port, and Iranshahr airport, plus, for the first time since April, **bridges** (railway bridges on the Tehran–Mashhad route / Golestan province). Stated rationale: "degrade ability to threaten freedom of navigation." Iranian Health Ministry: **14 killed, 78 wounded** over the two days (incl. 3 killed at a Sirik fishing pier).
- ★ **Iranian retaliation, July 9 — wider geography, near-zero effect:** IRGC/army drones and missiles at **four countries:** Kuwait (Arifjan / Ali Al Salem — a Patriot battery targeted; 3 ballistic + 1 cruise missile + 10 drones **all intercepted**; 1 person injured, stable), Bahrain (Juffair / Sheikh Isa fuel depots — intercepted), Qatar (early-warning/satellite sites — no impacts reported), and **Jordan — first time since the June 11 Azraq strikes: 10 ballistic missiles at Al Azraq Air Base, 8 intercepted, zero casualties or damage.**
- ★ **Zero US casualties either day** — the single most important non-escalation fact of the week (the one Kuwait injury was not specified as US personnel).
- ★ **Friday July 10 — a contested lull: no US-confirmed strike wave overnight Thursday–Friday, but Iranian state media reported fresh US strikes near Asaluyeh (South Pars energy hub) — unconfirmed by the US, with outlets explicitly flagging conflicting reports on any pause. Some US-official-attributed reporting describes a deliberate strike-then-pause posture to let diplomacy work. Trump, Friday: Iran "asked us to continue 'talks.' We have agreed to do so... but the Cease Fire is OVER!"**
- ★ **Khamenei buried; talks may resume July 11:** Khamenei was buried early Friday July 10 at the Imam Reza shrine, Mashhad (some July 9 wires said July 9 — dating conflict noted; July 10 is the later/primary report). Talks are reported to resume July 11 — *Al Arabiya via a Times of Israel liveblog: single-source relay, not confirmed by Qatar or State.* Qatari negotiators traveled to Tehran in coordination with the US, and a mediator swarm has been active since Wednesday (Qatar PM–Araghchi call, Pakistan, Turkey, Egypt, Saudi Arabia, UN Guterres).
- ★ **No formal MoU withdrawal by either side (explicit as of July 10).** Iran calls the US strikes a "gross war crime" and an MoU violation and says it won't negotiate under attack — yet per Trump it requested continued talks. The 60-day window to ~Aug 16 is intact. (Signing date: June 17 "Islamabad MoU" per the better-sourced reports; one outlet says June 14 — conflict noted.)
- ★ **Hormuz — worst readings of the crisis: the US Navy-led JMIC raised its transit advisory from "substantial" to "severe" — the highest tier, "deliberate hostile action" likely. Thursday traffic "virtually ground to a halt" (Insurance Journal); volume estimates conflict — ~50% of pre-war (Al Jazeera) vs a ~92% drop (Sunday Guardian, weaker source) — with transponders off obscuring the truth. War-risk cover now 2–6% of hull value (vs ~3% on July 8; wartime peak 10%), quotes priced hours before transit; syndicates advising a freeze on bookings west of the strait. The US publicly insists Iran "does not control" the strait. Background: Iran declared the strait shut ~June 22; pre-attack throughput was ~39–41% of pre-crisis per the unofficial straits.live tracker — *single-source.***
- ★ **Oil FELL despite 170 targets struck — de-escalation being priced: Brent ~\$78.02 July 8 → ~\$76.3–77.0 July 9 (settle \$76.30 per CNBC; TradingEconomics \$76.97) → ~\$76.00–76.80 July 10 (–\$2.45 d/d per Fortune's 6:15am ET print — that delta and the ~\$77 July 9 level reference different snapshots); WTI under \$72. Attribution: the pause plus talks hopes. Brent never took out the ~\$80 June 19 baseline.**

- ★ **BTC decoupled and rallied:** July 9 it held above \$62K with a "muted reaction" while oil rose and gold fell; July 10 it rose +3.5% to near \$64K (intraday low ~\$61,850), +4.2% on the week (7-day per CoinDesk; Fri-Fri trackers show ~+2.8%), ~\$28B volume; ETH \$1,760 (+2.6%). Attribution per CoinDesk: Asian chip/AI rally, yen +0.6%, weak dollar, liquidation-driven reversal — explicitly not Iran-driven. (That is a market move plus reporter attribution, not an institutional estimate.)
- **Oil re-sanctioned — wind-down on track:** Treasury revoked the MoU oil waiver July 7 (GL X → GL X1): no new Iranian oil sales; in-process deals get grace to July 17, proceeds into blocked interest-bearing accounts; China/India refiners re-exposed to secondary sanctions. No new developments July 9–10.
- **How this round started — tanker attacks, night of July 6–7:** the IRGC fired ≥2 missiles at commercial ships in/near the Strait of Hormuz. Two merchant vessels hit that night: Qatari LNG carrier *Al Rekayyat* (struck ~8nm off Limah, Oman — engine-room fire, crew abandoned ship) and Saudi crude tanker *Wedyan* (damaged); a third vessel was hit within 24 hours — three hit in total — and four more tankers turned back. Tehran did not officially claim responsibility.
- **The pattern:** on June 27 an Iranian one-way attack drone hit the tanker *M/T Kiku* (Panama-flagged, 2M+ bbl of crude); the US struck targets in Iran the same day, and the IRGC hit US sites in Kuwait and Bahrain on June 28. The ceasefire has now cracked at least three times since April (June 7–8, June 27–28, July 6–9) — the rounds getting closer together and bigger.
- **Diplomacy background:** indirect technical talks in Doha, June 30–July 2 ended with "positive progress" claimed but no breakthrough; two concrete outcomes — agreement to release the first \$3B tranche of ~\$6B in Qatar-held frozen Iranian funds, and an MoU-violations reporting channel. Sticking points: Hormuz transit fees (Iran: will "definitely" charge; US rejects) and the rest of the frozen funds.
- **Israel is out of this round:** no direct Israel–Iran exchange since June 7–8, and Israel was not a participant in the July 7–9 strikes (Netanyahu visited Haifa naval base July 7, "eye to eye" with Trump). A July 10 Times of Israel liveblog report of Israel joining the strikes is *single-source and unconfirmed — treat as rumor*. Israel–Hezbollah simmers on (Rubio announced an Israel–Lebanon "framework deal" June 26) but is not the July driver.
- **The odds:** Polymarket "US invades Iran before 2027" last verified at 14.5% (up from 11.5% on the strikes) — *a ~July 8 print; no fresh July 10 print obtained, label stale*. "Hormuz traffic normal by July" collapsed to 4.5%; "regime falls in 2026" ~2.45% (both ~July 8–9, secondhand). "MoU withdrawal by Aug 15" (26% on July 8) and "final deal by Dec 31" (35.5% on July 8): *current prints unverified — Polymarket pages unfetchable July 10*.
- **The baseline (still true, still load-bearing):** June 2025 "12-Day War" — BTC dipped to a ~\$98,225 intraday low (June 22, 2025), reclaimed \$107k+ by June 25, a fast V. The far larger 2026 regime-change war (Feb 28 → Apr 8, 2026; Khamenei killed Feb 28, confirmed by Iran March 1) still didn't crater crypto on Iran-specific grounds.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

The upside is still the "buy-the-invasion" rebound. Anchors: Russia–Ukraine (Feb 24, 2022) — BTC fell ~8% to a ~\$34,300 intraday low, posted a +14.5% up-day on Feb 28, ended ~+25–29% above the low within a week (~+38% by late March). June 2025 rhymed: ~\$98k dip, fully recovered within a week.

The live test just returned its first reading: July 8's escalation bought only a ~2–3% dip to ~\$61.7k, and by July 10 BTC was back near \$64K, +4.2% on the week (7-day per CoinDesk; Fri–Fri trackers show ~+2.8%) — though that rally is attributed to chips, the yen, and liquidations, not an Iran V, so don't score it as one. A desensitized market means shallower dips and smaller Vs. The bigger prize is the settlement scenario: a signed deal plus the reported ~\$300B reconstruction fund re-pricing the whole region after oil re-sanctioning. Still a thin sample; the Prize doesn't feed the math — it tells you what the lean is worth acting on.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case this is wrong

- BTC is a risk asset here, not a safe haven — and the oil-shock path still has numbers. Goldman's April scenario: Brent averages >\$100 in 2026 if Hormuz stays largely shut another month (\$120 Q3 / \$115 Q4); JPMorgan: \$120–130 if disruption persists through Q3, ~\$150 in a full-closure worst case. Brent at ~\$76 today doesn't retire those scenarios — the strait is on a "severe" advisory with traffic at crisis lows; if that persists, the inflation shock arrives late, not never, and crypto falls *with* equities.
- It keeps breaking. The ceasefire has now cracked at least three times since April — June 7–8, June 27–28, and the July 6–9 round that grew to ~170 targets and put bridges on the target list for the first time since April. The rounds are getting closer together and bigger. Each one, "time heals" gets directly contradicted.
- The rally may be complacency, not resilience. BTC rising through 170 strikes proves nothing about Iran — the move is attributed to chips and the yen. The market is pricing a contained flare-up (Brent \$76, below the June baseline); that pricing is fragile to a US-casualty event, a formal MoU withdrawal, or a confirmed full closure — any one repricing gaps down, not drifts.
- Thin sample, still. The bullish long-term read rests on ~2 dip-and-recover events, both in a bull regime — geopolitical shocks don't always V-recover.

The Triggers

Dated events ahead — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. Reset July 10, 2026

DATE	EVENT	MEANS
July 11, 2026	Talks reportedly resume (Al Arabiya via Times of Israel — single-source relay, unconfirmed)	Off-ramp reopens — partial re-rate up if confirmed
July 17, 2026	Iranian oil-sale waiver wind-down completes (GL X1, revoked July 7)	Sanctions bite — Tehran's pressure to escalate or deal rises
By ~Aug 16, 2026	Formal MoU withdrawal or 60-day window expires unsigned (Polymarket withdrawal odds last verified 26% on July 8 — current print unverified)	Diplomacy dead — re-rate 1/3/6-month down
Any time	Confirmed full Hormuz closure / Brent through \$90	Oil shock confirmed — re-rate near-term down hard
Any time	US-casualty event (Bahrain/Kuwait/Qatar/Jordan bases, Gulf shipping)	Escalation spiral — re-rate down hard
By Dec 31, 2026	Final US–Iran nuclear deal signed (Polymarket last verified 35.5% on July 8 — current print unverified)	De-escalation confirmed — re-rate up across windows

The flip line: a US invasion / regime-change round two, or a sustained *full* Hormuz closure with Brent north of \$100 = treat the dip-buy thesis as broken. June's flip line was "wider war + Hormuz oil shock" — as of July 10 we are still halfway there: the strait sits at a "severe" advisory with traffic at crisis lows, but Brent is at ~\$76, *below* the June baseline. A contained strike-pause-strike loop that burns out keeps the long-term Bull.

My Decision

🕒 **UPDATED DRAFT — JULY 10, 2026 · AWAITING MY STAMP**

Draft P: 42 / 49 / 56 / 70 / 83 · My Weight: 25% · My Impact: 7

The June committed scores (50 / 55 / 62 / 75 / 85, committed June 19, 2026) remain the last human-stamped values. This draft nudges the near and mid windows *up* off the July 8 draft (40 / 47 / 55 → 42 / 49 / 56): zero US casualties across two nights, retaliation that was almost fully intercepted, a Friday pause, an intact MoU with a mediator swarm, and Iran asking to keep talking all beat the July 8 worst case. The long arc holds at 70 / 83.

Still a dip-watching pillar, not a panic-selling one — the 1-month lean stays Mild Bear because the strike-pause-strike regime can re-fire any night and Hormuz sits at a "severe" advisory. The 6-month lean tips back to Mild Bull. The accident paths into ~Aug 16 remain the real risk — watch those, not the headlines.

Override any P and re-stamp — the master blend recomputes.

What Changed Since Last Check

Re-researched July 10, 2026 (previous update July 8, 2026)

- The threatened strikes happened, then escalated a notch: ~80 targets July 8, ~90 more early July 9 (~170 cumulative), target set widened to bridges for the first time since April; Iranian Health Ministry counts 14 killed, 78 wounded.
- Retaliation widened to four countries — including Jordan (first since June 11) — but with near-zero effect: almost everything intercepted, one non-US injury in Kuwait, and zero US casualties either day — the week's most important non-escalation fact.
- Friday lull: no new US strike wave overnight Thursday–Friday; Trump says Iran asked to continue talks and the US agreed — "but the Cease Fire is OVER!"
- Diplomacy track intact: Khamenei buried July 10; talks reported to resume July 11 (single-source relay, unconfirmed); Qatari negotiators in Tehran; no formal MoU withdrawal by either side; the ~Aug 16 window stands; July 17 waiver wind-down on track.
- Hormuz worsened even as oil fell: JMIC advisory raised to "severe" (highest tier), Thursday traffic near a halt, war-risk cover 2–6% of hull value — yet Brent *fell* to ~\$76 on pause-and-talks pricing, and BTC rallied +3.5% to near \$64K on drivers explicitly not Iran.
- Score re-rates (July 8 draft → July 10 draft):
- 1mo 40 → 42 — the Friday pause, zero US casualties, Iran requesting talks, and BTC shrugging off the strikes beat the July 8 worst case; but the strait is severe-shut and strike-pause-strike can re-fire any night.
- 3mo 47 → 49 — the MoU formally alive with a mediator swarm, plus the July 17 waiver stick, pushes toward a deal inside the ~Aug 16 window; retaliation shown to be performative caps the tail risk.
- 6mo 55 → 56 — invasion still priced ~14.5% and both sides keep choosing calibrated exchanges over rupture; the deal-by-year-end path is intact.
- 1yr 70 → 70 · 3yr 83 → 83 — unchanged; 48 hours of choreographed strikes doesn't move the structural thesis (eventual resolution + risk-asset re-rating).

Sources

Retrieved & graded July 10, 2026 — click and judge the quality yourself. Official statements are quoted inside the wire reporting below; then prices, then betting markets (sentiment only).

- The escalation (official statements via wire reporting): NPR — second-night US strikes (July 9) · Bloomberg — attacks traded for second day (July 9) · CENTCOM release — second strike round (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · Al Jazeera — second-night strikes & the peace process (July 9) · Gulf News — Bushehr/Chabahar/Iranshahr strikes, Kuwait intercepts (July 9) · The National — Iran attacks on Gulf states & Jordan (July 9) · RFE/RL — Hormuz/Jordan (403 at retrieval; cited via search) · NPR — Hormuz tanker attacks (July 7) · CBS live — Treasury waiver revocation, CENTCOM 80+ targets, IRGC 85-site claim (July 8) · Al Jazeera — Trump "ceasefire over" quotes (July 8).
- Diplomacy: Al Jazeera — talks status, no formal MoU withdrawal, Khamenei burial (July 10) · Al Jazeera — mediators urge MoU compliance (July 9) · CNN live — Trump on talks / "Cease Fire is OVER", Qatari team to Tehran (July 10; 451 at retrieval, cited via search) · Times of Israel — July 11 talks date via Al Arabiya (single-source relay, unconfirmed) · Times of Israel liveblog — Israel-join-strikes report (July 10; single-source, unconfirmed) · Al Jazeera — Doha outcomes (July 2).
- The oil waiver: CBS — GL X1 waiver rescission (July 7) · Axios — waiver revocation (July 7) · The Hill — sanctions detail (July 7).
- The prices: Fortune — Brent ~\$76.00–76.80 (July 10) · Kitco/Reuters — oil fell as markets weigh strikes (July 9) · Sunday Guardian — Brent ~\$76 / WTI <\$72 (July 10; weaker source) · CNBC — Brent \$78.02 / WTI \$73.52 (July 8) · Insurance Journal — traffic near halt, war-risk 2–6% of hull value (July 9) · The New Arab — JMIC "severe" advisory · LMA — insurance availability vs safety concerns · (Hormuz traffic magnitude conflicts across outlets — ~50% of pre-war vs ~92% drop — transponders off; pre-attack throughput figures are from the unofficial straits.live tracker — single-source) · CoinDesk — BTC steady above \$62K (July 9) · CoinDesk — BTC to ~\$64K on chips/yen, not Iran (July 10) · Fortune — BTC ~\$61.7K (July 6, pre-escalation) · CoinDesk — ~\$450M liquidations (July 8).

- The odds (sentiment only, not fact): **Blockchain.News** — invasion odds 11.5% → 14.5% (~July 8 print — stale; no fresh July 10 print obtained) · **Blockchain.News** — Hormuz-normal-by-July odds collapse to 4.5% (403 at retrieval; cited via [search](#)) · *Polymarket pages unfetchable July 10 — MoU-withdrawal and deal-by-Dec-31 current prints unverified; last verified July 8: 26% / 35.5%.*